

Scott 1985 RG Notes

Scott, James C. *Weapons of the Weak: Everyday Forms of Peasant Resistance*.

Bethany, Connecticut: Brevis Press, 1985.

1 Main Idea

2 General Notes

- While literature has previously focused on collective peasant actions en masse, argues that the driving factor of political development is decentralized, lower-level everyday resistance (also particularly targeting indirect resistance)
- Everyday resistance can include intentional inefficiency, destruction of property, false compliance, feigned ignorance, foot-dragging... all construct a degree of protection against exploitative bodies
- Everyday resistance is rationally viable particularly because the costs are low and there exists no meaningful collective action barrier to overcome
- Resistance is often symbolic in some part – actions are heavily judged by meaning and ideological intentions
- As landowners and wealthier farmers gained representation/influence/wealth, common peasants (evidence here is from Sedaka in Malaysia) responded with everyday rather than organized resistance in an effort to preserve previous economic structure, rights, situation, etc.
- Characterizes much peasant activity as at a level below organized revolt, but instead efforts to slowly squeeze against higher classes or other influential bodies/groups

3 Important Specific Factual Claims

- Uses Green Revolution as a natural experiment

4 Connections

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5 My Critiques

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